The Survey

The survey team left at dawn and walked [L]
north along the dry river bed, counting
every heron they saw on the far bank.

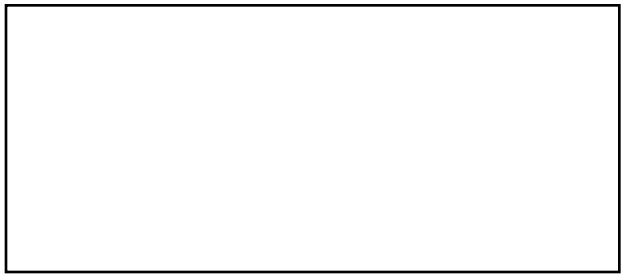

Figure 2. The ford at low water.

By noon the heat was heavy and they
rested under the old fig near the ford.
Later they crossed at the shallow bend
and climbed the ridge to look for owls.

In the afternoon the second team took [R]
the boat downstream to the salt flats,
where the water turned grey and still.
They logged forty plovers and a pair
of spoonbills feeding in the shallows.
At dusk they tied up below the levee
and waited for the frogs to start up.